

Flamingo Rise

REAL TOOLS. BRIGHTER TOMORROWS.

PAUSE.
BREATHE.
BE HERE.
YOU'VE GOT THIS.



Grounding Exercises

FOR EMOTIONAL BALANCE
WORKBOOK

Simple, practical
exercises to help you
feel calmer, more present
and more in control –
whenever life feels
overwhelming.



Same
Brilliant You
Just Bolder

QUICK & EASY TECHNIQUES

REDUCE ANXIETY

FEEL MORE PRESENT

USE ANYWHERE, ANYTIME

BUILD EMOTIONAL RESILIENCE

SMALL STEPS.
REAL CHANGE.
A CALMER, BRIGHTER YOU.



GROUNDING EXERCISES FOR EMOTIONAL BALANCE

Quick ways to bring your attention back to what is happening here and now.

The original guide had three exercises: 5-4-3-2-1, counted breathing and focusing on the sensations of a textured object. Good bones. Slightly more 'laminated handout in a waiting room' than FlamingoRise resource. ■

Grounding is not about convincing yourself everything is fine. It is about giving your attention something concrete to work with when thoughts, feelings or stress are taking up all the bandwidth.

Some people like sensory techniques. Some need movement. Some prefer facts, conversation or practical tasks. The useful grounding exercise is the one that helps YOU become more present and able to decide what happens next.

If an exercise makes you feel worse, stop. You do not need to force yourself through it just because somebody put it on a wellbeing worksheet.

Wellbeing note: Grounding exercises are general coping tools, not treatment or emergency support. If you are in immediate danger or experiencing a crisis, seek appropriate urgent help.

1. THE CLASSIC 5-4-3-2-1

5 things I can see right now:

4 things I can physically feel or touch:

3 things I can hear:

2 things I can smell:

1 thing I can taste - or one taste I can imagine/remember if nothing is convenient:

Did directing my attention outward change anything?

TRY / NOTICE

TRY IT: Do the full sequence, shorten it, change the numbers or skip a sense that does not work for you. The structure is there to give your brain a job, not to test your counting.

What did I notice?

2. OBJECT GROUNDING

Choose an object. What does it feel like - smooth, rough, soft, hard, warm, cool?

How heavy is it?

What colour, shape or small details can I notice?

Can I describe it as if the person reading my description cannot see it?

What changed while I concentrated on the object?

TRY / NOTICE

TRY IT: Keys, jewellery, a mug, fabric, a stone, a pen - use whatever is already there. You do not need to purchase a mystical grounding pebble for £19.99.

What did I notice?

3. BREATHING WITHOUT TURNING IT INTO HOMEWORK

Does paying attention to breathing help me or make me more aware/anxious?

What pace feels comfortable?

Would counting help my focus?

What signs tell me to stop and return to ordinary breathing?

TRY / NOTICE

TRY IT: Let your breath stay easy. If comfortable, count 3 on the inhale and 4 on the exhale for a few rounds. Do not strain, and do not force breath holds. The aim is to settle attention, not win the breathing Olympics.

What did I notice?

4. FEET, FLOOR, CHAIR

What can I feel where my feet meet the floor?

What pressure can I feel where my body meets the chair, bed or sofa?

Can I press my feet down gently and notice the resistance?

What temperature or texture can I notice?

Does physical contact with a surface help me feel more present?

TRY / NOTICE

TRY IT: Notice three points where your body is supported. That's it. No need to imagine roots growing into Mother Earth unless you genuinely enjoy that sort of thing.

What did I notice?

5. FACTS, NOT STORIES

Where am I right now?

What date/day/time is it?

What has ACTUALLY happened in the last five minutes?

What am I assuming, predicting or remembering?

What is one fact I can verify right now?

What decision, if any, actually needs making this minute?

TRY / NOTICE

Grounding can be cognitive as well as sensory. Sometimes the most useful thing is separating what is happening from what your brain fears might happen.

What did I notice?

6. NAME THE ROOM

Name five ordinary objects around me.

Pick one colour and find as many examples of it as I can.

Find three straight lines, three curves and three different textures.

Read three pieces of visible text slowly.

What did my attention do while I searched?

TRY / NOTICE

**Give your brain a boring little scavenger hunt. Boring can be remarkably useful
when your thoughts are being dramatic.**

What did I notice?

7. TEMPERATURE & SENSATION

What temperature feels comfortable and noticeable - cool water, a warm mug, fresh air, a cool flannel?

What sensation is strong enough to notice without being painful?

Does changing temperature help me refocus?

What should I avoid because of my health, skin, circulation or sensory needs?

TRY / NOTICE

Use safe, comfortable sensation. Grounding does not require ice baths, pain or shocking your body into submission.

What did I notice?

8. MOVEMENT GROUNDING

Does walking help me think more clearly?

What simple movement can I safely do where I am?

Can I notice the rhythm of walking, stretching, rocking, tapping or moving my hands?

Would music make movement more useful?

What movement is realistic for my body today?

TRY / NOTICE

Movement counts. Adapt it to your mobility, pain, energy and surroundings. 'Do what your body can safely do' beats forcing yourself through somebody else's perfect technique.

What did I notice?

9. SOUND & VOICE

What is the nearest sound I can hear?

What is the furthest sound I can hear?

Would humming, singing, talking or reading aloud help me stay present?

Is there a familiar song, podcast or person's voice that helps?

Which sounds make things worse?

TRY / NOTICE

Sound can give attention somewhere concrete to land. Silence is not compulsory.

What did I notice?

10. THE PRACTICAL TASK RESET

What tiny practical task could I do for two minutes?

Would washing a cup, folding something, making a drink, sorting a drawer or feeding a pet help?

Can I describe each step while I do it?

Does completing something small change how scattered I feel?

Am I grounding - or using tasks to avoid something that genuinely needs dealing with?

TRY / NOTICE

Sometimes 'mindfulness' is making a cup of tea and paying attention while you do it. We don't need to make everything fancy.

What did I notice?

11. PEOPLE AS GROUNDING

Who helps me become more present rather than more wound up?

What could I ask them to do - talk normally, remind me where I am, distract me, sit with me, help with a practical problem?

What kind of reassurance helps?

What kind of reassurance turns into an endless loop and stops helping?

What could I text when I need contact but cannot explain everything?

TRY / NOTICE

Other people can be part of your toolkit. The goal is support, not requiring one person to regulate every feeling for you.

What did I notice?

12. BUILD MY 'OH SHIT' GROUNDING PLAN

My earliest signs that I need grounding are...

The fastest technique for me is...

A discreet technique I can use around other people is...

A movement-based option is...

A sensory option is...

A facts/reality-check option is...

Someone I can contact is...

Something I should NOT do because it makes me worse is...

TRY / NOTICE

Write the plan while your brain is available. Future You does not need a twelve-step wellness ceremony; Future You needs something usable.

What did I notice?

MY 60-SECOND GROUNDING CARD

The page for when you cannot be arsed reading the rest of the workbook.

LOOK: Name 3 things I can see.

FEEL: Notice 2 points of physical contact.

HEAR: Find 1 sound.

FACT: Say where I am and what is happening NOW.

ACTION: Choose one useful next step.

PERSON: Who can I contact if I need more support?

I do not have to solve everything in the next sixty seconds.

7-DAY GROUNDING EXPERIMENT

Try different methods before deciding you're 'bad at grounding'.

DAY 1: Use 5-4-3-2-1 once.

DAY 2: Ground with an ordinary object.

DAY 3: Try a facts-not-stories check.

DAY 4: Use safe movement.

DAY 5: Use sound or voice.

DAY 6: Do a two-minute practical task deliberately.

DAY 7: Choose the two techniques worth keeping in your personal plan.

FINAL REFLECTION

Which technique brought me back to the present fastest?

Which one irritated me or did nothing?

Do I respond better to senses, movement, facts, tasks or people?

What are my earliest signs that I am becoming overwhelmed?

What can I use in public without anybody even noticing?

What belongs on my 60-second grounding card?

When do I need more than a grounding exercise?

A FINAL FLAMINGORISE NOTE

Grounding is not about pretending the difficult thing disappeared.

It is about getting enough of yourself back into the present moment to work out what the difficult thing actually needs.

Sometimes that's another grounding technique. Sometimes it's rest, food, medication, a boundary, a conversation, leaving somewhere, professional help or dealing with the actual bloody problem.

Use the tool. Don't worship the tool.

Rise. Heal. Soar.